Scams cost Singapore S$913.1 million in 2025

SilverGuard AI

We flag the scam script, not the voice.

2 The problem

15%
of 2025 victims were 65+

S$37,000
average senior loss, highest [1]

20.7%
of citizens are 65+ [2]

S$913.1 million covers all scam types [3]. Voice-clone "family emergency" calls exploit time pressure and willingness to help [4].

3 Blind spots

- Listeners often take clones for real [5]
- Detectors weaken on real-world audio [6]
- ScamShield can't block WhatsApp calls [7]

4 Three layers

1 Before answering
Guardian Alert: unknown calls silenced, never blocked

2 During the scam
Pause & Verify, Scam Check, Family Drill

3 Before money moves
Partner-bank cooling-off check, *later*

Ring silenced
Call still shows on screen; app notifies "Marcus has been told"

same time

Guardian alerted
WhatsApp message with number and time, target under 10 s

5 How it decides

Script cues: money request, secrecy, new number, urgency, authority, emotional pressure.

- ⚠ High risk
- Check with family
- No warning signs found

Never "safe".

6 Audio, screenshots and chat text never leave the phone. Only the alert does.

signed packs

Privacy line
Audio, screenshots and chat text never cross it

event metadata

7 Business case

Users: seniors
Payers: adult children
Partners: telco, bank (later)

Seed ask: **S$500,000** for MVP, 200-household pilot

8 How we changed

Assignment 1 [Team: one-line position]

Feedback Business lens, peer-reviewed sources, local context.

Now Script, not voice; family in the loop; partners later.

9 Validation

Grandparents said:

Quote needed | Quote needed | Quote needed

Scam Check demo: 15/15 on a 15-message test set our team wrote with AI assistance; real-world accuracy unmeasured.

10 Risks and limits

- ⚠ **False alarms** → never "safe"
- ⚠ **Family misuse** → senior controls guardian
- ⚠ **Dialects** → "Couldn't check; ask family"
- ⚠ **iPhone, app calls** → Scam Check still works

11 Sources

[1] MHA, 2026. [2] NPTD et al., 2025. [3] SPF, 2026a. [4] Stajano & Wilson, 2011. [5] Barrington et al., 2025. [6] Müller et al., 2022. [7] ScamShield, n.d.

AI use: Claude drafted; team checks and edits. Log: repository.

QR code: link to be decided